

Tolga Çakan

Industrial Engineer · Lean, Quality & Continuous Improvement

tolgacakan.vercel.app Istanbul, Turkey tolgacakan@gmail.com +90 542 262 00 42
linkedin.com/in/mehmettolgacakan

PROFILE

Industrial engineer (Istanbul Bilgi University, 2026) who learned the Toyota Production System on the shop floor at Toyota Sakarya. Finds where a process loses time, quality or space and proves the cause with data. In a team of five, turned a sock maker's scrap, warehouse and ergonomics problems into changes the plant adopted, winning Best Senior Design Project. Seeking an operations or manufacturing graduate programme.

EXPERIENCE

- Mar-Jul 2025 **Sports Marketing Intern, De Marke Agency**
 - Worked in the PR team on site at two UEFA tournaments; wrote the monthly social media KPI report.
- Jan-Feb 2025 **Product Intern, BTCTurk Technology**
 - Built dashboards and market reports in a Scrum product team; benchmarked rival exchanges.
- Jun-Jul 2024 **Engineering Intern, Toyota Motor Manufacturing Turkey** Sakarya
 - Joined Assembly Logistics for Corolla and C-HR, learning JIT, Jidoka, 5S and Kanban on the gemba.
 - Followed parts from dock receiving through devanning to set-parts supply (SPS) at the line.
 - Co-ran a Kaizen study of the intern programme with two fellow interns: 61% efficiency vs 82% ideal.
 - Traced root causes with a 4M fishbone and presented a standard programme flow to management.
 - Wrote a TPS handbook for future interns.

PROJECTS

- 2025-2026 **Industry project, ÖRS Textile** senior design · team of 5 · Best Senior Design Project Award
 - Traced 87.8% of scrap to three causes with Pareto: needle breakage, yarn moisture, machine faults.
 - Moved needle care from run-to-failure to preventive maintenance, more than halving its cost.
 - Introduced a yarn moisture meter to curb moisture scrap; it paid for itself in about 40 days.
 - Redesigned the labelling station with MTM, cutting time per piece by 43%.
 - Re-slotted the warehouse by ABC in a digital twin, more than doubling lower-floor storage.
 - Built an ISO 2859-1 incoming quality control app (React/TypeScript) with QR carton traceability.
 - Assessed ergonomics with heart rate, RULA and NIOSH; planned worker rotation and a lifting aid.
- 2026-present **Co-founder, TAB Marketing** [tab-marketing-site.vercel.app](#)
 - Started a venue-feedback service with two friends after seeing guests had no easy way to be heard.
 - Run design, supplier production and on-site setup for 250+ custom pieces across cafés and hotels.

SKILLS

- Lean & TPS Kaizen · 5S · JIT · Jidoka · standard work (İSF) · Kanban · takt · Andon · muda, mura, muri · genchi genbutsu
- Problem-solving Root cause analysis · 4M fishbone · Pareto analysis · cost-benefit and payback
- Quality ISO 2859-1 incoming quality control · preventive maintenance · QR traceability
- Flow & layout Material flow (Devan, SPS) · ABC slotting · warehouse layout · MTM · RULA and NIOSH ergonomics · worker rotation
- Data & tools Excel (advanced, VBA) · Python · SQL · Power BI · Blender (digital twin) · React/TypeScript (QC app)
- Languages Turkish (native) · English (professional)

EDUCATION

- Istanbul Bilgi University, BSc Industrial Engineering (2026)
- Serdivan Fen Lisesi (science high school), Sakarya

AWARDS, PROGRAMMES & CERTIFICATES

- Best Senior Design Project Award, Istanbul Bilgi University (2026), ÖRS Textile project; top five of term, presented at CSRP 2026
- FlyRank AI Internship (Jul-Aug 2026). Remote, unpaid educational programme: five reviewed assignments and an accepted capstone
- [AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations](#), Anthropic (Jul 2026)

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

- Vice President & Operations Lead, Atatürkçü Düşünce Kulübü (2021-2024). Ran 10+ forums; largest panel drew 4,000+
- Editorial Director, Bilgi Blockchain Club (2021-2024). Commissioned and edited the club's publications and shaped its forum and speaker programme
- International: European Summer School, Blockchain to Financial Markets, Prague (2025) · HeForShe Erasmus+ Youth Exchange, Estonia (Dec 2023)
- Drums & songwriting, *son sek'*. One album, two singles, live shows ([Spotify](#))

PUBLICATION

- Book chapter, "Blockchain ve Eğlence Sektörü", Nobel Akademik Yayıncılık, 2022